October 2026

KATHRYN H. MCMAHON

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EDUCATION

PhD	Geography, University of California, Santa Barbara (Expected June 2027)
MA	Geography, University of California, Santa Barbara (2023)
BA	Geography & Global Studies, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill (2021)

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Humid-heat shifts conceptions and increases pregnancy termination risks in Nigeria
Nina Brooks, Cascade Tuholske, **Kathryn McMahon**, Kwaw Andam
Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 123 (44), e2321152122, 2026

Does humidity matter? Prenatal heat and child health in South Asia
Kathryn McMahon, Kathy Baylis, Stuart Sweeney, Chris Funk
Science Advances, 11 (51), eadx3010, 2025

Climate change, social vulnerability and child nutrition in South Asia
Kathryn McMahon, Clark Gray
Global Environmental Change, 71, 102414, 2021

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Will climate-induced humid heat deepen child stunting disparities in South Asia?
Kathryn McMahon, Kathy Baylis, Stuart Sweeney, Chris Funk
Demography, Under Review

Does the Social Vulnerability Index Correspond with Exposure to Heat? A Test Case Using California Census Tracts
Elizabeth Ackert, **Kathryn McMahon**, Gabrielle Benoit, Hannah Malak, Frank Davenport, Kathy Baylis, Shraddhanand Shukla
Natural Hazards, Under Review

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Compound effects of humid heat and air pollution on infant mortality
Kathryn McMahon, Ann James, Simran Koul, Kathy Baylis
In Prep

FUNDING

2025: Helen Hansma Fellowship Award, UCSB ($10,000)
2025: Broom Center PAA Travel Grant, UCSB ($500)
2024: Schmidt Family Foundation Research Accelerator Award, UCSB ($8,000)
2023-2026: Chancellor's Fellowship, UCSB ($125,000)
2023: Dangermond Travel Award, UCSB ($600)
2023: Broom Center PAA Travel Grant, UCSB ($500)
2022: Graduate Climate Conference Travel Grant, UCSB ($140)
2021-2023: NSF Graduate Research Fellowship in Geography ($150,000)
2017-2021: NC SECU People Helping People Scholarship, UNC ($10,000)

AWARDS AND HONORS

2026: Geography Excellence in Research Award, UCSB
2026: All-UC Demography Conference Graduate Student Poster Award
2025: IPUMS Global Health Research Award
2023: All-UC Demography Conference Graduate Student Poster Award
2021: IPUMS Global Health Research Award
2021: Population Association of America Poster Award
2020: Alexandre Senior Thesis Research Award, UNC
2020: Summer Award for a Research-Intensive Course, UNC

PRESENTATIONS (#oral session presenter; %poster presenter; *invited speaker)

2026: "Compound Effects of Humid Heat and Air Pollution Exposure on Infant Mortality." American Geophysical Union Annual Meeting#
2026: "Climate change, social vulnerability, and child growth trajectories in South Asia." UCSB Anthropology Colloquium Series*
2026: "Does humidity matter? Prenatal heat and child health in South Asia." World Conference of Environmental and Resource Economists#
2026: "Will climate-induced heat and humidity deepen long-run health disparities in South Asia?" All-UC Demography Conference%
2025: "Global compound effects of extreme heat and air pollution exposure on infant mortality." American Geophysical Union Annual Meeting%
2025: "Will climate-induced heat and humidity deepen long-run health disparities in South Asia?" Population Association of America Annual Meeting#
2024: "Does humidity matter? Prenatal heat and child health in South Asia." Association of Environmental and Resource Economists Annual Meeting%
2024: "Does humidity matter? Prenatal heat and child growth in South Asia." UCSB Geography Department 50th Anniversary Event%
2023: "Does humidity matter? Prenatal heat and child growth in South Asia." American Geophysical Union Annual Meeting%

2023: "Does humidity matter? Prenatal heat and child growth in South Asia." All-UC Demography Conference%
2023: "Does humidity matter? Prenatal heat and child growth in South Asia." Population Association of America Annual Meeting#
2022: "Does humidity matter? Prenatal heat and child growth in South Asia." Graduate Climate Conference%
2022: "Climate change, social vulnerability and child nutrition in South Asia." Population Association of America Annual Meeting#
2021: "On the Road Again? Climate Anomalies and Migration Trends in Indonesia." Population Association of America Annual Meeting%

TEACHING, MENTORSHIP, AND SERVICE

2025-2026: Instructor, Math and Statistics Boot Camp, UCSB
2024-2026: Volunteer, Graduate Application Materials Assistance program, UCSB
2024: Data analysis services for the Central Coast Alliance United for a Sustainable Economy (CAUSE)
2023-2024: Department of Geography Graduate Student Mentor, UCSB
2021-2023: Mentorship of four UCSB undergraduates (Two won a 2023 Library Award for Undergraduate Research)
2021-2024: Department of Geography Outreach Committee, UCSB
2020-2021: Volunteer, North Carolina Museum of Life and Science

Referee for: *Population and Environment*

MEDIA MENTIONS (selected)

"Humid heat may increase the risk of premature birth. But aspirin could help," The Conversation, May 7, 2026

"Will climate change make us smaller?" BBC News Brasil, May 2, 2026

"Hot, humid conditions during pregnancy undermine child health much more than heat alone," The Current, Dec. 19, 2025

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data management & visualization, advanced statistical analysis: R and Stata SE
Spatial analysis and mapping: ArcGIS, QGIS, R
Calibration and field installation of environmental data loggers
Design, implementation, and analysis of surveys and semi-structured interviews

REFERENCES

Kathy Baylis: Professor, Department of Geography, University of California, Santa Barbara
Stuart Sweeney: Professor, Department of Geography, University of California, Santa Barbara
Chris Funk: Director, Climate Hazards Center, University of California, Santa Barbara